

Ministry of Forests, Lands and Natural Resource Operations

BC River Forecast Centre

Update - High Streamflow Advisory: North Coast and Central Coast

Issued: 1 October 2012 1:30 PM

The BC River Forecast Centre is **updating** the **High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- North Coast (including Stewart, Prince Rupert, Nass, Kitimat and surrounding areas)
- Central Coast (including Bella Bella, Bella Coola, Kingcome, Owikeeno Lake, and surrounding areas)

An intense frontal system is forecast to deliver heavy rain throughout regions of the North and Central Coast of British Columbia today. Precipitation totals of 50 to 80 mm for the North Coast and 110 mm for the Central Coast are expected by this evening. The frontal system is expected to move through by late afternoon.

River levels have been responding to this precipitation and are expected to continue to rise for the remainder of the day:

- The Kitimat River below Hirsch Creek (08FF001) is currently flowing at $915 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$, which is a 1-year return period flow, and the water level is rising at approximately 16 cm/hour. It is forecasted that the flow will be rising to $1440 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$, which is a 2-year return period flow, in a day if 100 mm rainfall is coming by this evening.
- Hirsch Creek near the Mouth (08FF002) is currently flowing at $150 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$, which is a 1-year return period flow, and the water level is rising at approximately 12 cm/hour. It is forecasted that the flow will be rising to $290 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$, which is a 2-year return period flow, in a day if 100 mm rainfall is coming by this evening.
- The Salloom River near Hagensborg (08FB004) is currently flowing at $45 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$, which is a 1-year return period flow, and the water level is rising at approximately 15 cm/hour. It is forecasted that the flow will be rising to $80 \text{ m}^3/\text{s}$, which is a 2-year return period flow, in a day if 100 mm rainfall is coming by this evening.

The River Forecast Centre will continue to monitor conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.